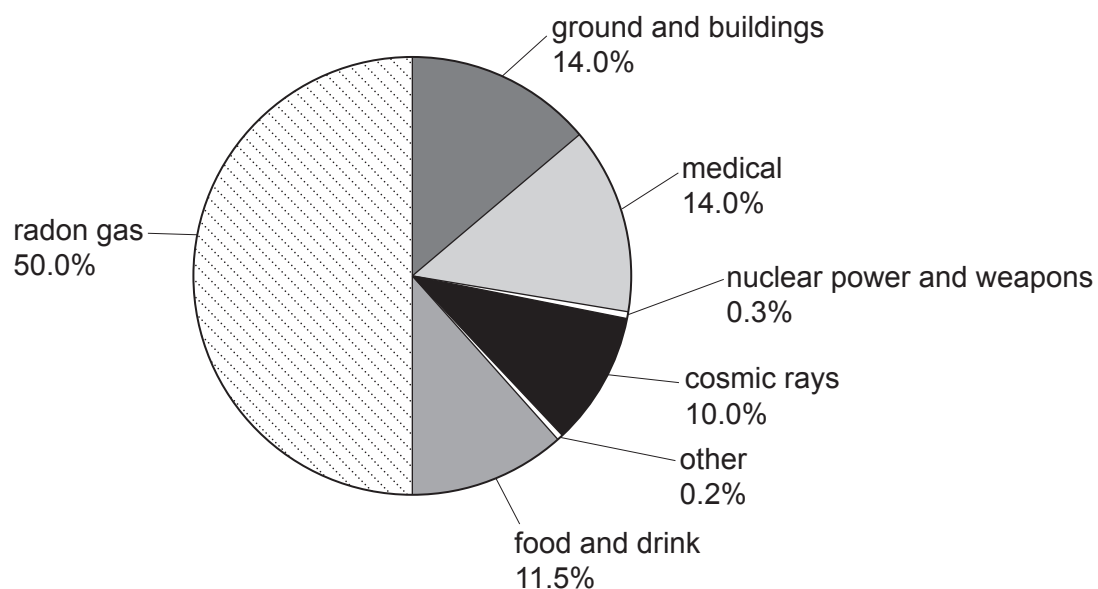


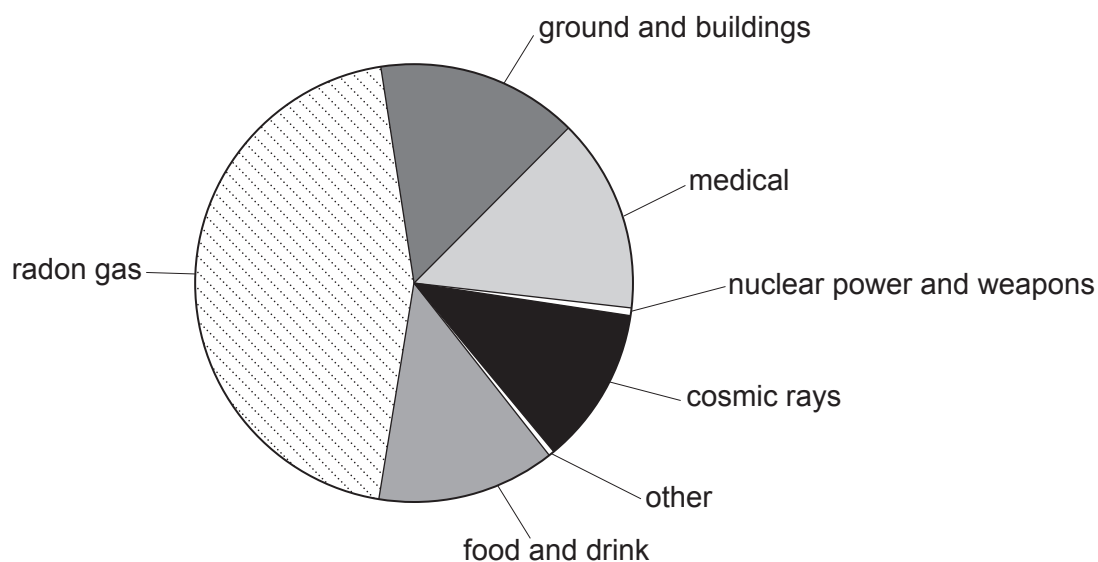
9. A group of students is investigating background radiation.

- (a) They find the pie charts below, which show the background radiation in 3 different locations, A, B and C, in the UK.

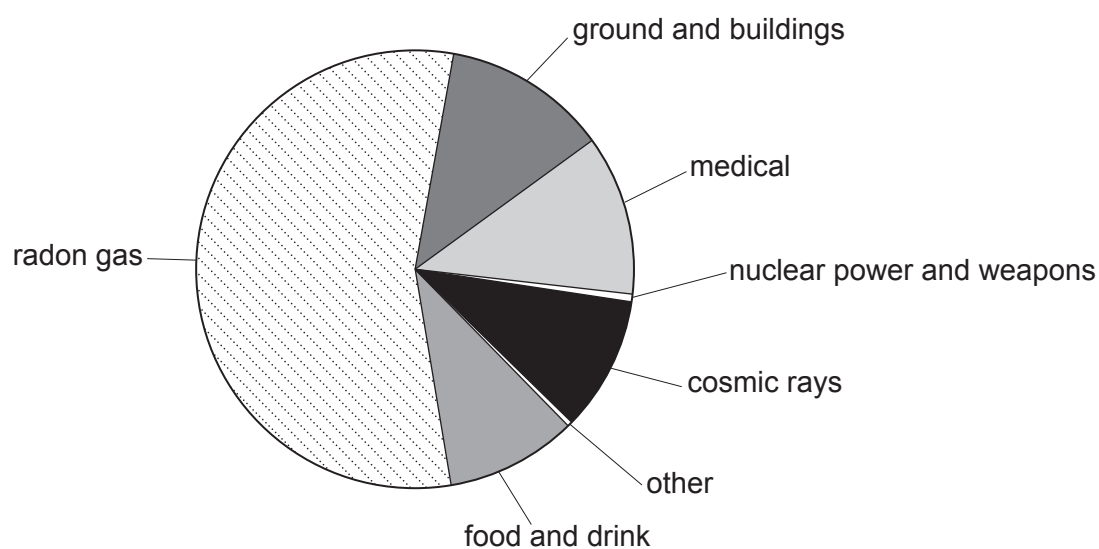
**Location A**



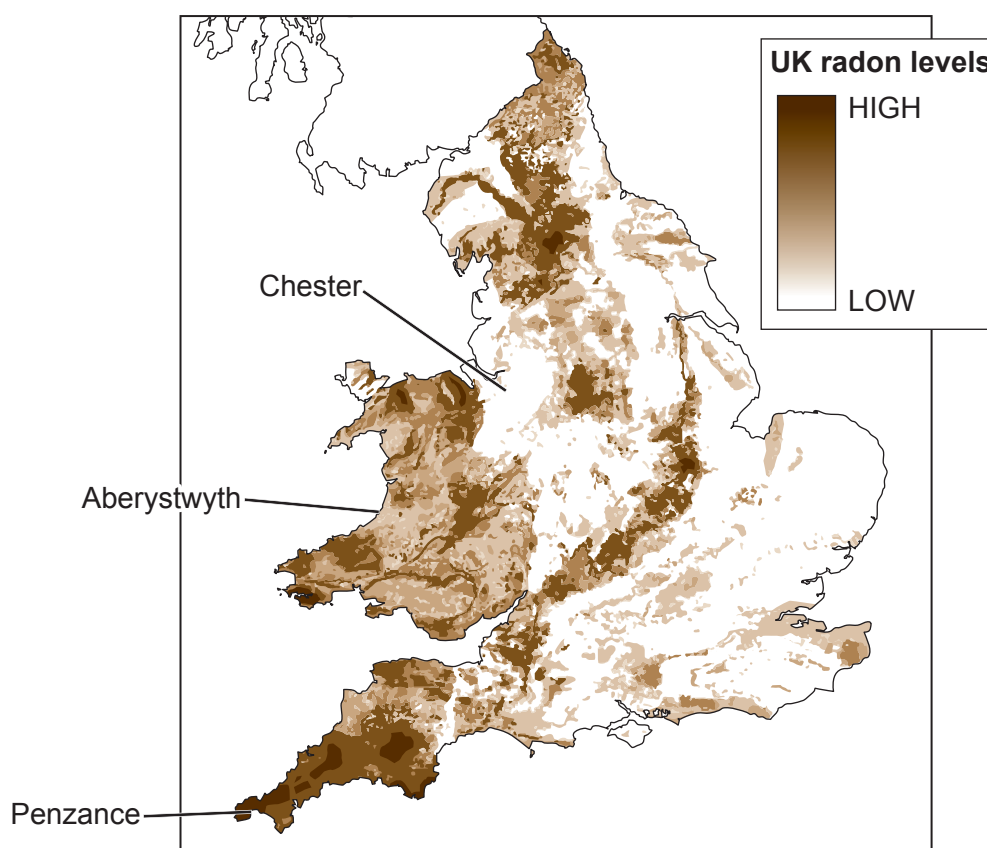
**Location B**



### Location C



The map below shows radon levels across the UK.  
The 3 locations, A, B and C are shown on the map.  
The darker the area on the map the higher the levels of radon.



- (i) Adam studies the diagrams and concludes that **location A** must be Aberystwyth. Explain whether you agree. [2]

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- (ii) Their teacher measures the background count in **location A**. The teacher records 30 counts in 60 seconds.

- I. Determine the count rate in counts per second. [1]

count rate = ..... cps

- II. Use information from the pie chart to determine how many of the 30 counts are due to radon gas. [1]

counts due to radon = .....

- (iii) Chloe states that people are more at risk from man-made sources of background radiation than natural sources. Use data from the pie chart for **location A** to explain whether you agree. [2]

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(b) The table shows how much radiation people receive from some different sources.

| Source of radiation                          | Radiation received (units) |
|----------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| mean background radiation (per year)         | 2.7                        |
| 8 hour flight from London to New York        | 0.09                       |
| dental X-ray                                 | 0.005                      |
| chest X-ray                                  | 0.014                      |
| CT scan of head                              | 1.4                        |
| CT scan of chest                             | 6.6                        |
| worker in a nuclear power station (per year) | 0.18                       |

Workers in nuclear power stations have their exposure to radiation carefully monitored.

If they receive a total of **20 units** of radiation from all sources including background radiation in one year, they can no longer work with radiation.

- (i) Sophia works in a nuclear power station.  
In one year, she flies from London to New York and back.  
She also has a dental X-ray and a CT scan to her chest.  
Sophia is worried about the level of radiation she has been exposed to.

Use data to explain whether it is still safe for her to work with radiation. [2]

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- (ii) Jack states that workers in a nuclear power station are exposed to more radiation in one year than airline pilots flying on the London to New York route.

Use data to explain whether he is correct. [2]

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